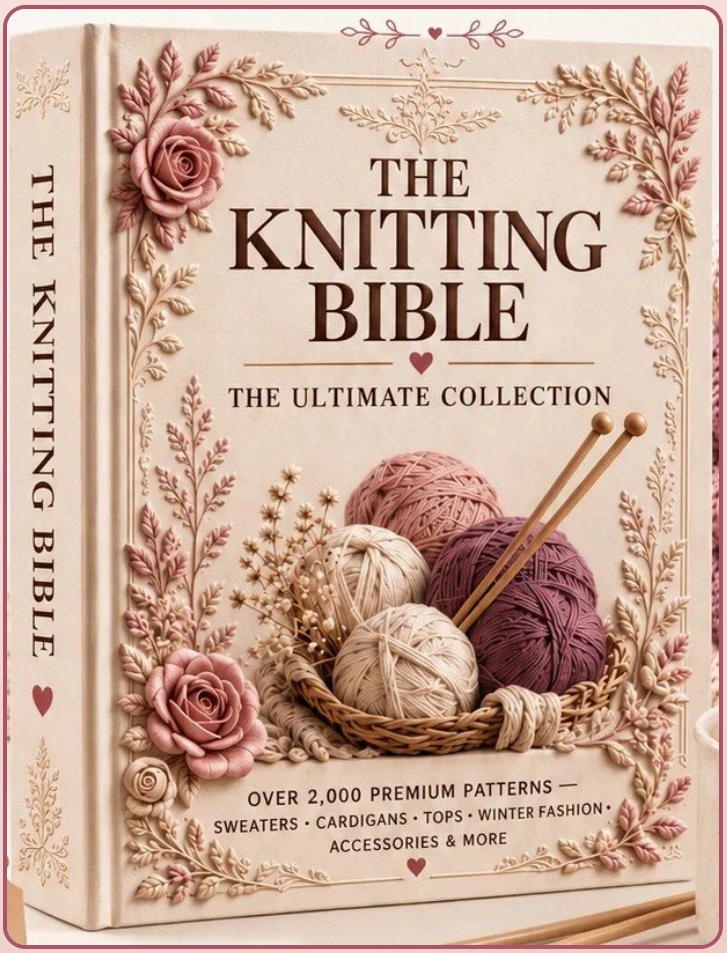
BONUS 4

First Steps in Loom Knitting

A gentle introduction to knitting spools and looms



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Next step

> *Welcome. If you have ever wanted to make something warm, soft and handmade but felt nervous about holding two sharp needles, loom knitting is for you. A knitting loom is a ring, rectangle or row of pegs. Instead of juggling needles, you wrap yarn around the pegs and lift loops over them with a small hook. The pegs hold your stitches for you, so nothing slips off when you set the project down to answer the door. This guide takes you from your very first wrap to ten complete projects, one gentle step at a time. Read it once through, then keep it beside you as you work.*

> **Safety first**
>
> Looms, hooks and yarn needles are small, and so are the pieces you will make. Keep scissors and tools away from young children, and never leave small projects such as bracelets, cords or finished toys within reach of small children or pets without supervision, because small parts and loose cords are a choking and strangling risk. Cut yarn carefully, away from your fingers. Take breaks to stretch your hands and wrists, and stop if you feel pain. Wash finished pieces gently before use, following the yarn label.

1. What Loom Knitting Is

Loom knitting makes the same loops and fabric that needle knitting makes. In needle knitting, one loop at a time is worked while the rest wait on the needle. On a loom, every stitch of the row sits on its own peg, and you move around the pegs working them one by one. The finished fabric is made of rows of interlocked loops, and it stretches, drapes and wears just like knitted fabric.

There are only a few moves to learn: cast on by wrapping, make a knit stitch by wrapping and lifting a loop over, make a purl stitch by pulling a loop through from the other side, and bind off. Because you can see every stitch standing on a peg, mistakes are easy to spot and easy to fix. Within a single afternoon most beginners have a small piece of fabric growing on the loom, and that first piece is a wonderful feeling.

Why beginners love it

- **No needles to drop.** The pegs hold every stitch securely, so you can pause at any moment.
- **Fast results.** A first cord can be finished in an afternoon and a first hat in a weekend.
- **Easy on the hands.** Many knitters with sore or stiff hands find the large, slow motions of loom knitting comfortable.
- **Clear learning.** You can see what each stitch looks like, which helps you understand how knitted fabric is built.
- **Low cost.** One loom and a few skeins of yarn will make dozens of projects.

What loom knitting does differently

The fabric is slightly looser than needle knitting for the same yarn, and a loom makes only the stitches it has pegs for. This means that the width of your project is set by the number of pegs you use and the distance between them. That is why this guide always gives you a loom type, a peg count and a gauge for every project. Follow those three numbers and your piece will come out the size described.

2. Types of Looms

Looms come in several shapes. You do not need all of them. A single round loom and a long loom will let you make almost every project in this guide, and a small knitting spool will make all the cords.

Round looms

A round loom has pegs in a ring, so it makes tubes that are ideal for hats, cowls, mitts and ear warmers. Round looms are sold in different peg counts, commonly 12, 24, 36 and 40 or more, and in different gauges. You can also knit flat panels on a round loom by working back and forth across part of the ring.

Long (rectangular) looms

A long loom has pegs along both long sides. You can knit flat panels back and forth on one side, or make a wide fabric or a double-thick layer using both sides. Long looms are best for scarves, dishcloths, blankets and any flat piece. In this guide, flat projects use one long side unless stated otherwise.

Rakes

A rake is a straight bar with a single row of pegs. It makes flat panels only, and it is light and simple. Many beginners start on a rake because there is only one direction to think about. Any flat project in this guide can be made on a rake with the right number of pegs.

Adjustable looms

An adjustable loom has two sliding halves that lock together, so you can make it long or round and change the number of pegs in use. It is a good choice if you want one loom that does many jobs.

Knitting spools (French knitting)

A knitting spool, also called a French knitting spool or a knitting nancy, is a small tube with four to six pegs around a central hole. It makes a narrow knitted cord that grows out of the bottom as you work. This is also called corking. It is the quickest way to learn the wrap-and-lift motion.

Peg spacing and gauge

The **gauge** of a loom is the distance from the center of one peg to the center of the next. It decides which yarn the loom takes and how dense the fabric will be. The table lists the common gauges, and every project in this guide names the gauge it uses.

GAUGE	PEG SPACING	TYPICAL USE
Extra-fine	1/4 in (6 mm)	Lace, fingering and baby yarns; fine, delicate fabric
Fine	3/8 in (9.5 mm)	Sport and DK yarns; coasters, headbands, mitts
Medium	1/2 in (12 mm)	Worsted yarn; the all-around gauge for hats, scarves and cloths

GAUGE	PEG SPACING	TYPICAL USE
Large	3/4 in (19 mm)	Bulky yarn; fast, chunky cowls, blankets and hats
Extra-large	1 in (25 mm)	Super bulky yarn; very quick, loose, soft fabric

A quick rule helps you plan sizes: the **loom circumference** is about the peg count times the peg spacing. A 24-peg loom with 3/8 in spacing is about 9 in around (24 x 3/8 = 9). A 36-peg loom with 1/2 in spacing is about 18 in around (36 x 1/2 = 18). The knitted fabric relaxes a little smaller than this, and then it stretches to fit.

3. Tools You Need

You need very little to begin. Most looms come with a hook, but it is worth knowing what each tool does.

- **Knitting loom or spool.** Choose the type and gauge in the project you want to make.
- **Loom hook or pick.** A small hook with a handle that lifts loops over pegs. A hook with a smooth tip is easier on the yarn than a sharp one.
- **Yarn needle.** A large blunt needle with a big eye, used to weave in ends, to sew seams and to gather loops when you bind off.
- **Scissors.** Small, sharp and kept in a safe place.
- **Stitch markers.** Small clips or rings used to mark the first peg of a round, or a peg where you must change something. A scrap of contrasting yarn tied loosely around the peg works as well.
- **Measuring tape.** To check width and length as you go.
- **Notebook.** To write down your row count. This is the most useful tool of all.

> **Tip: mark the first peg**
>
> On a round loom, every round begins and ends on the same peg. Put a stitch marker or a scrap of contrasting yarn on that peg. You will always know where you are, and counting rounds becomes easy.

4. Choosing Yarn by Loom Gauge

The wrong yarn is the most common reason a first project disappoints. Yarn that is too thick will not fit around the pegs; yarn that is too thin makes holes and a loose, floppy fabric. Match the yarn to the gauge using the table.

LOOM GAUGE	PEG SPACING	YARN WEIGHT	STRANDS	APPROX. ROWS PER INCH
Extra-fine	1/4 in (6 mm)	Lace to fingering	1 (or 2 of lace)	6
Fine	3/8 in (9.5 mm)	Sport to DK	1	4
Medium	1/2 in (12 mm)	Worsted	1	3
Large	3/4 in (19 mm)	Bulky	1	2
Extra-large	1 in (25 mm)	Super bulky	1	1.5 to 2

LOOM GAUGE	PEG SPACING	YARN WEIGHT	STRANDS	APPROX. ROWS PER INCH
Small spool (4 pegs)	about 3/16 in	Sport to DK	1	about 5 in a cord

The row counts in this guide use the rows-per-inch numbers in the table. Your own gauge may differ a little, so knit a few rows and measure. If you get fewer rows per inch, add rows to reach the length you want; if you get more, knit fewer.

Choosing a good beginner yarn

- A smooth, plied yarn in a light or medium color, so you can see each loop clearly.
- A wool blend or an acrylic that is soft and washable.
- Cotton or a cotton blend for dishcloths and coasters, because it absorbs water and tolerates hot water.
- Avoid fuzzy, hairy or very slippery yarns at first. They hide the stitches and are hard to fix.
- Avoid yarns that split when you pick them up; they turn mistakes into knots.

> **Check the label**
>
> Look at the label on the yarn. It gives a weight category, the yardage and the care instructions. For gifts and household items, choose yarn that can be machine washed and dried.

5. Holding the Yarn and Wrapping the Pegs

Everything in loom knitting starts with the wrap. Work your first wraps slowly, with a smooth, even tension. A relaxed wrap makes even stitches; a tight wrap makes stitches that are hard to lift and a stiff fabric.

Setting up

1. Place the loom on a table or in your lap with the pegs pointing up and away from you.
2. Put your yarn ball on your left if you are right-handed (on your right if you are left-handed) so it unwinds freely. A center-pull skein is ideal.
3. Hold the working yarn between the thumb and the first two fingers of your free hand, with a gentle tension. Imagine holding the string of a small kite: firm enough to keep it, loose enough to let it move.
4. Hold the hook in your working hand like a pencil.

The direction of work

On a round loom, wrap around the pegs in one direction, either always clockwise or always counterclockwise. Right-handed knitters usually work counterclockwise. Choose one direction and keep to it for the entire project. On a flat panel, you work from one end to the other, then back.

6. E-Wrap Cast-On

The e-wrap is the basic cast-on. It is called an e-wrap because the yarn makes the shape of a lowercase e around each peg. It puts one loop on every peg you will use.

1. Make a slip knot and place it over the first peg, or hold a tail of about 6 in (15 cm) against the loom with your finger.
2. Take the working yarn to the outside of the next peg and hold it there.
3. Bring the yarn around the peg: in front of the peg from the outside, behind it on the inside, then back toward the outside. The yarn forms the shape of a lowercase e and ends on the outside of the loom.
4. Move on to the next peg and repeat. Pull the yarn so the loops lie snugly but are not tight.
5. Continue around every peg you are using. On a flat panel, wrap the pegs from one end to the other, and then stop.
6. Wrap the pegs once more in the same way. Each peg now has two loops: the lower loop is the cast-on, and the upper one is the new wrap.
7. Using the hook, lift the lower loop up and over the upper loop and off the peg. Do this on every peg. You now have one loop on every peg, and your cast-on is complete.

> **Tip: tail and tension**
> Leave a tail of 6 in (15 cm) at the beginning. You will weave it in at the end. Check that every peg has exactly one loop before you begin. A peg with no loop makes a hole; a peg with two loops makes a bulge.

7. The Knit Stitch (U-Stitch)

The knit stitch is the basic stitch of loom knitting. This guide uses the u-stitch, the easiest version for a beginner, because the yarn goes around each peg in a loose U shape. It makes a smooth, flat knit stitch.

Step by step

1. Have one loop on every peg. Hold the working yarn on the outside of the loom, at the peg where you will start.
2. Take the yarn around the first peg in a U-shape: from the outside, around the inside of the peg, and back to the outside. The yarn lies on top of the loop already on the peg. Do not cross the yarn over itself.
3. Move on to the next peg in the same direction and wrap it in the same way. Continue until every peg has a new loop on top of the old one. Keep the wraps loose and even.
4. Return to the first peg. With the hook, pick up the lower loop, lift it up and over the upper wrap, and over the top of the peg. Let it drop off the peg to the inside.
5. Move on to the next peg, and work it in the same way. Continue until every peg has been worked.
6. You have made one round or one row. The loom looks the same as before: one loop on every peg. Repeat steps 2 to 5 for each new row.

As you work, a tube of knitting begins to fall through the middle of a round loom, or hang below the pegs of a flat loom. Give it a gentle tug down every few rows to even out the tension. If you pull too hard, you will stretch the stitches; if you never pull, the fabric will bunch up under the pegs.

> **Tip: do not wrap tightly**
>
> Wrap the yarn around each peg loosely. If the wraps are tight, the loop will not lift over the top of the peg without a struggle. The yarn is stretchy and will take up slack when you pull the fabric down.

8. The Purl Stitch

A purl stitch is the reverse of a knit stitch: the bump sits on the side facing you. Purl stitches are used to make textures such as garter and ribbing, and to make a flat fabric that does not curl.

How to purl

1. Have one loop on the peg. Hold the working yarn on the inside of the loom, in front of the peg.
2. Insert the hook through the loop on the peg from below, going up, so the hook comes out on the inside of the peg.
3. Hook the working yarn and pull it down through the loop, making a new loop.
4. Lift the old loop off the peg and place the new loop on the peg in its place.
5. Move on to the next peg and repeat.

Purling is slower than knitting, and it is normal to make the first few purl stitches clumsily. If your loom came with printed or video instructions for the purl stitch, follow them as well. The idea is the same: the new loop is pulled through the old loop from the other side.

What the stitches make

PATTERN	HOW TO WORK IT	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
Stockinette	Knit every row (or every round on a round loom)	Smooth V stitches on one side, bumps on the other; flat panels curl at the edges
Reverse stockinette	Purl every row	Bumpy outside, smooth inside
Garter	Knit one row, purl one row (flat panels only)	Rows of ridges; lies flat and does not curl
Ribbing	Knit one peg, purl one peg across the row	Stretchy vertical lines; good for cuffs and brims

9. Flat Panel or In the Round

There are two ways to work: round and round to make a tube, or back and forth to make a flat panel.

In the round

On a round loom you wrap every peg in a ring and keep going in one direction. The fabric forms a seamless tube with no gap. Stockinette in the round has smooth stitches on one side only and does not curl at the

sides, so it is the best way to make hats, cowls and mitts. When you reach the peg with the marker, one round is done.

Flat panel

To make a flat panel, use only part of the loom: the pegs in a straight row, on a long loom or a rake, or part of a round loom. Wrap and lift from the first peg to the last peg, then turn and work back from the last peg to the first. The working yarn runs along the front of the pegs each time.

1. At the end of a row, the working yarn is at the last peg. Wrap this peg and keep going back in the other direction.
2. Do not wrap past the end pegs. If you wrap an extra peg, you will add a stitch.
3. Count your rows. One trip across is one row; one trip across and back is two rows.

> **Tip: edges**
> Flat stockinette tends to roll at the edges. For a flat edge, add a few rows of garter at the beginning and at the end, or use garter throughout.

10. Binding Off

Binding off closes the last row and locks the stitches so they do not unravel. There are two useful methods: the basic bind-off, which makes a neat edge, and the gathered removal, which closes a tube like the top of a hat.

Basic bind-off

1. Finish the last row, and cut the working yarn, leaving a tail of about 12 in (30 cm), or longer if you will use it for a seam.
2. Move the loop from the first peg onto the second peg, so the second peg holds two loops.
3. Lift the bottom loop over the top loop and off the peg. The peg now has one loop.
4. Move that loop to the next peg and repeat.
5. At the last peg, you have one loop. Cut the yarn, thread the tail through the loop, and pull it tight.
6. Remove the work from the loom, and weave in the ends with the yarn needle.

Gathered removal

For the top of a hat or for the end of a tube, use the gathered removal. It closes the tube into a neat, flat top.

1. Cut the working yarn, leaving a tail of about 18 in (46 cm).
2. Thread the tail through the yarn needle.
3. Passing the needle through the loop on each peg, from the outside to the inside, lift the loop off the peg onto the yarn. Do this all the way around the loom.
4. When all the loops are on the yarn, pull the tail to cinch the top closed.
5. Take the needle through the center of the gathered loops several times, tie off, and weave the tail into the inside.

> **Tip: a loose bind-off**
>
> A bind-off that is too tight will make the edge pucker and will not stretch. Keep your tension loose, or work the bind-off with a slightly larger hook.

11. Changing Yarn and Fixing Mistakes

Joining a new ball of yarn

When your yarn runs short, or when you wish to change colors, finish the row if possible and then change at the start of a row.

1. Leave the old yarn hanging on the outside of the loom with a tail of at least 4 in (10 cm).
2. Take the new yarn and wrap the next peg with it, leaving a 4 in (10 cm) tail.
3. Continue working with the new yarn, and for the first few stitches hold the old tail and new tail together with the working yarn so they stay put.
4. When the piece is finished, weave in both tails on the inside with the yarn needle.

Avoid tying a knot in the middle of a stitch row; knots show and can pop through. If you must tie, tie at the edge, where you can hide it.

Fixing mistakes

- **Dropped stitch:** If a loop falls off a peg, find the loop and place it back on the peg. If it has unraveled down a few rows, use the hook to lift each rung of the ladder back up, one row at a time, until you reach the peg.
- **Peg with no loop or two loops:** If you skipped a wrap, wrap the peg and lift the loop over. If you wrapped twice, lift the extra loop off.
- **Unraveling a row:** Lift the loops off the pegs, pull the yarn out, and place the loops back on the pegs one at a time, being careful not to twist them.
- **Twisted stitches:** If a loop is twisted, take it off the peg and put it back so it lies flat.
- **Wrong direction:** If you wrap the wrong direction, the stitches will look different. Unwrap the row and start again.

12. Knitting Spool Cords (Corking)

The knitting spool is the quickest introduction to the whole system, and the cords it makes are useful for many things. A small spool has four pegs, and the cord is a narrow tube.

Step by step

1. Drop the yarn through the center hole of the spool from the top, until about 6 in (15 cm) comes out the bottom. Hold the tail against the base with one finger.
2. Wrap the working yarn around the first peg in a loose U shape or an e-wrap, going counterclockwise.
3. Wrap each of the other three pegs in the same direction. All four pegs now have a loop.

4. Wrap all four pegs a second time, so each peg has two loops.
5. With the hook, lift the lower loop on the first peg over the upper loop and off the peg. Repeat on the other three pegs.
6. Wrap the four pegs again, and lift the lower loops over the top loops. This is one row.
7. After about 5 rows, a short cord appears out of the bottom of the spool. Gently pull the tail down every few rows to help it feed through.
8. Keep going until the cord is as long as you want. A cord of 8 in (20 cm) needs about 40 rows in sport or DK yarn.
9. To finish, cut the yarn with a 12 in (30 cm) tail, thread it through the yarn needle, and take the needle through each loop on the pegs, lifting them off. Pull tight, and tie off.

> **Tip: do not give up at the beginning**
>
> The first several rows seem to do nothing, because the cord has not yet come out the bottom. Keep going. After the first five rows, it feeds through on its own.

What to make with cords

- Bracelets and friendship cords.
- Drawstrings for bags.
- Bookmarks and keychain loops.
- Hanging loops for towels and ornaments.
- Coiled coasters and trivets: sew a long cord into a flat spiral.
- Hair ties and wrist bands.
- Edge trim for a project, stitched down securely.

> **Safety for cords**
>
> Do not use long cords as necklaces, ties or pull cords on anything for babies or small children, and do not use cords near cribs. Keep cords on children's clothes very short, or leave them out.

13. Increases and Decreases

Shaping a project means adding or removing stitches. On a loom, each stitch lives on a peg, so shaping means changing the number of loops on the pegs.

Decreasing

To decrease, move a loop from one peg to the neighboring peg. That peg now has two loops, and the empty peg is out of use. On the next wrap, wrap the peg with two loops as one stitch, and lift both of the old loops over the new wrap. For a round project such as a hat, the empty pegs are left empty for the rest of the project.

- **Even decreases:** Move one loop at regular intervals around the loom, such as every 6th peg.

- **Edge decreases:** On a flat panel, move the loop on the end peg to the next peg in, so the panel narrows from one side.
- **Closing a crown:** Decrease in several rounds with plain rounds in between, then gather the last loops with the yarn needle.

Increasing

To increase, add another peg to the row. On a long loom or adjustable loom, wrap an empty peg at the end of the row with an e-wrap. On a round loom with every peg in use, you cannot add pegs, so shape with decreases instead.

- **Edge increase:** At the end of a flat row, e-wrap the next empty peg and continue.
- **Make one:** Lift the bar of yarn between two pegs, place it on an empty peg and work it as a stitch. This is only possible on a loom with spare pegs.

> **Tip: keep a count**
>
> After every decrease or increase row, count your loops and write the number in your notebook. A single missed decrease can throw off the whole hat.

14. Ten Complete Beginner Projects

Each project lists the loom, the gauge, the peg count, the number of rows, and the yardage. Yardages are approximate and include a little extra. Finished sizes are of the relaxed fabric before stretching. Rows per inch come from the table in section 4. Make a small swatch first if you want to check your own gauge.

Project 1: Cord Bracelet

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	Small knitting spool, 4 pegs
Yarn	Sport or DK weight, about 5 yd (4.5 m)
Rows	40 rows, about 8 in (20 cm) of cord
Finished size	8 in (20 cm) cord, tied to fit a wrist
Time	About 45 minutes

1. Thread the yarn through the spool, leaving a 6 in (15 cm) tail.
2. Wrap all 4 pegs, then wrap again, then lift the lower loops over (Section 12).
3. Keep working until you have 40 rows. Measure: the cord should be about 8 in (20 cm) at 5 rows per inch (40 / 5 = 8).
4. Finish with the gathered removal and leave a 6 in (15 cm) tail.
5. Tie the two tails together in a double knot to make a loop that slips over the hand, or sew on a clasp.

Make three cords in different colors and braid them together for a sturdier bracelet. Keep the bracelet loose enough that it can be taken off over the hand easily, and keep it away from small children.

Project 2: Square Coaster

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	Long loom or rake, fine gauge (3/8 in, 9.5 mm)
Pegs	12 pegs (12 x 3/8 = 4.5 in)
Yarn	Cotton or cotton blend, sport to DK, about 30 yd (27 m)
Rows	18 rows (18 / 4 = 4.5 in)
Finished size	4.5 in x 4.5 in (11.5 cm square)

1. Use 12 pegs in a row and e-wrap cast on.
2. Rows 1 to 3: purl every row. This makes a flat border that does not curl.
3. Rows 4 to 15: knit every row. That is 12 rows of stockinette.
4. Rows 16 to 18: purl every row. 3 + 12 + 3 = 18 rows.
5. Bind off loosely with the basic bind-off, and weave in the ends.
6. Make a set of four coasters.

Cotton makes a good coaster because it soaks up drips. Wash the coasters before the first use and let them dry flat.

Project 3: Dishcloth on a Long Loom

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	Long loom, medium gauge (1/2 in, 12 mm)
Pegs	16 pegs (16 x 1/2 = 8 in)
Yarn	Worsted cotton, about 70 yd (64 m)
Rows	24 rows (24 / 3 = 8 in)
Finished size	8 in x 8 in (20 cm square)

1. Use 16 pegs on one long side. E-wrap cast on.
2. Row 1 and every odd row: knit across.
3. Row 2 and every even row: purl across. This is garter stitch, and it lies flat.
4. Continue until you have 24 rows, ending with a purl row.
5. Bind off, and weave in the ends.

Garter stitch is thick and scrubby, a good texture for washing dishes. Wash it in hot water before using. Cotton shrinks a little, and it will get softer with every wash.

Project 4: Headband

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	Long loom, fine gauge (3/8 in, 9.5 mm)
Pegs	14 pegs (14 x 3/8 = 5.25 in)
Yarn	DK, about 150 yd (137 m)
Rows	76 rows (76 / 4 = 19 in)
Finished size	5.25 in x 19 in (13 cm x 48 cm), stretches to fit a head of about 21 to 22 in (53 to 56 cm)

1. Cast on 14 pegs with an e-wrap.
2. Knit row 1, purl row 2. Keep alternating (garter) until you have 76 rows, ending with a purl row.
3. Bind off loosely.
4. Join the two short ends with a seam: with the yarn needle and a tail, whipstitch the ends together, or sew a flat seam.
5. Weave in the ends.

A band worked in garter stretches well sideways and sits close to the head. If you want a softer fit, knit 80 rows instead (80 / 4 = 20 in).

Project 5: Simple Hat on a Round Loom

This hat comes in two versions. Both have a roll brim and a crown that decreases evenly in rounds. Both fit a head of about 20 to 22 in (51 to 56 cm), because the knitting stretches.

DETAIL	VERSION A	VERSION B
Loom	36-peg round loom, medium gauge (1/2 in)	24-peg round loom, large gauge (3/4 in)
Loom circumference	36 x 1/2 = 18 in	24 x 3/4 = 18 in
Yarn	Worsted, about 150 yd (137 m)	Bulky, about 100 yd (91 m)
Body rounds	18 rounds (18 / 3 = 6 in)	12 rounds (12 / 2 = 6 in)
Crown rounds	9 rounds	5 rounds
Total rounds	27	17

Version A: 36 pegs, worsted

1. E-wrap cast on all 36 pegs. Put a marker on peg 1.

2. Rounds 1 to 18: knit every round with the u-stitch. Pull the tube down gently now and then. The brim rolls up by itself.
3. Round 19 (decrease): move the loop from every 6th peg (pegs 6, 12, 18, 24, 30 and 36) to its neighbor. That is 6 loops moved, leaving 30 working pegs (36 - 6 = 30). Knit the round.
4. Round 20: knit 30 pegs.
5. Round 21 (decrease): move the loop from every 5th working peg, 6 loops in all, leaving 24 working pegs (30 - 6 = 24). Knit the round.
6. Round 22: knit 24 pegs.
7. Round 23 (decrease): move every 4th working peg, 6 loops, leaving 18 (24 - 6 = 18). Knit the round.
8. Round 24: knit 18 pegs.
9. Round 25 (decrease): move every 3rd working peg, 6 loops, leaving 12 (18 - 6 = 12). Knit the round.
10. Round 26: knit 12 pegs.
11. Round 27 (decrease): move every 2nd working peg, 6 loops, leaving 6 (12 - 6 = 6). Knit the round.
12. Cut the yarn with an 18 in (46 cm) tail. Use the gathered removal to close the top through the last 6 loops. Weave in the ends.

Check: 18 body rounds plus 9 crown rounds make 27 rounds. There are 5 decrease rounds (19, 21, 23, 25 and 27) and 4 plain rounds (20, 22, 24 and 26), and 5 + 4 = 9.

Version B: 24 pegs, bulky

1. E-wrap cast on all 24 pegs, and mark peg 1.
2. Rounds 1 to 12: knit every round (12 rounds = 6 in at 2 rounds per inch).
3. Round 13 (decrease): move every 4th peg, 6 loops, leaving 18 (24 - 6 = 18). Knit the round.
4. Round 14: knit 18 pegs.
5. Round 15 (decrease): move every 3rd working peg, 6 loops, leaving 12 (18 - 6 = 12). Knit the round.
6. Round 16: knit 12 pegs.
7. Round 17 (decrease): move every 2nd working peg, 6 loops, leaving 6 (12 - 6 = 6). Knit the round.
8. Gather the last 6 loops and close the top. Weave in the ends.

Check: 12 body rounds plus 5 crown rounds make 17 rounds in total.

> **Tip: fit**
> If the hat is too snug, try a larger loom in the next one. If it is too loose, use a thinner yarn or fewer pegs. Always check the fit on the person before you start the crown.

Project 6: Chunky Cowl

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	36-peg round loom, large gauge (3/4 in, 19 mm)

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom circumference	36 x 3/4 = 27 in
Yarn	Bulky, about 200 yd (183 m)
Rounds	20 rounds (20 / 2 = 10 in)
Finished size	About 10 in (25 cm) tall, large enough to pull over the head

1. E-wrap cast on 36 pegs and mark peg 1.
2. Knit 20 rounds with the u-stitch.
3. Bind off loosely with the basic bind-off.
4. Weave in the ends.
5. Wear the cowl doubled for a snug fit, or fold the top edge over for a cozy double layer.

The bottom and top edges will roll, which makes a soft, rounded edge. If you prefer a flat edge, work the first two and the last two rounds as ribbing.

Project 7: Fingerless Mitts

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	24-peg round loom, fine gauge (3/8 in, 9.5 mm)
Loom circumference	24 x 3/8 = 9 in
Yarn	DK, about 80 yd (73 m) per mitt, 160 yd (146 m) for the pair
Rounds	24 rounds (24 / 4 = 6 in)
Fits	Hands of about 7 to 8.5 in (18 to 22 cm) around the knuckles

1. E-wrap cast on all 24 pegs and mark peg 1.
2. Rounds 1 to 8: knit in the round for the cuff (2 in, 8 / 4 = 2).
3. Rounds 9 to 14: knit 6 more rounds (1.5 in) to reach the thumb.
4. Rounds 15 to 20: thumb opening. Choose 4 pegs for the thumb and leave their loops alone. Knit back and forth, as a flat panel, across the other 20 pegs for 6 rows (1.5 in). 24 - 4 = 20.
5. Rounds 21 to 24: return to working in the round, across all 24 pegs, for 4 rounds (1 in). The thumb slit is now closed at the top.
6. Bind off loosely, and weave in the ends. Use the tail to neaten the corners of the thumb opening.
7. Make a second mitt in the same way.

Count the total: 8 + 6 + 6 + 4 = 24 rounds, which is 6 in. Try the mitt on after round 14; if you want a longer mitt, add rounds to the cuff.

Project 8: Baby Blanket Panel

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	Long loom, large gauge (3/4 in, 19 mm)
Pegs	14 pegs (14 x 3/4 = 10.5 in)
Yarn	Soft washable bulky, about 280 yd (256 m) per panel
Rows	72 rows (72 / 2 = 36 in)
Finished size	10.5 in x 36 in (27 cm x 91 cm) per panel; three panels sewn together make about 31.5 in x 36 in

1. E-wrap cast on 14 pegs.
2. Knit row 1, purl row 2, and keep alternating (garter) until you have 72 rows.
3. Bind off loosely.
4. Make two more panels in the same way, for three in total (3 x 280 = 840 yd; 3 x 10.5 = 31.5 in wide).
5. Lay the panels side by side, and sew them together with a flat seam using the yarn needle.
6. Weave in all the ends carefully.

> **Baby safety**
>
> A knitted blanket is for cuddling and for the stroller or sofa. It is not for the crib. Avoid loose ends and dangling pieces, use soft machine-washable yarn, and wash the blanket before use. Do not add buttons, beads or ties.

Project 9: Easy Scarf

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	Long loom, medium gauge (1/2 in, 12 mm)
Pegs	12 pegs (12 x 1/2 = 6 in)
Yarn	Worsted, about 370 yd (338 m)
Rows	168 rows (168 / 3 = 56 in)
Finished size	6 in x 56 in (15 cm x 142 cm)

1. E-wrap cast on 12 pegs.
2. Knit row 1, purl row 2, and keep alternating (garter) until you have 168 rows. Use a row counter or tally marks.
3. Bind off loosely.
4. Weave in the ends.
5. Optional: add fringe by cutting 8 in (20 cm) strands, folding each in half and pulling the loop through the end stitch.

The scarf hangs from the pegs as it grows, so it will not get in your way. If you are running out of yarn, begin the next ball at the start of a row.

Project 10: Ear Warmers

DETAIL	SPECIFICATION
Loom	36-peg round loom, medium gauge (1/2 in, 12 mm)
Loom circumference	36 x 1/2 = 18 in
Yarn	Worsted, about 80 yd (73 m)
Rounds	12 rounds (12 / 3 = 4 in)
Finished size	4 in (10 cm) wide band; stretches to fit a head of 20 to 22 in (51 to 56 cm)

1. E-wrap cast on all 36 pegs and mark peg 1.
2. Knit 12 rounds with the u-stitch. The edges will roll.
3. Bind off loosely with the basic bind-off.
4. Weave in the ends.

Try the band on before you bind off if you can, by lifting it carefully off the loom onto scrap yarn. If it is too tight, bind off very loosely, or use a larger loom next time. Do not decorate it with buttons or beads if it is for a child.

15. Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Holes in the fabric	A peg was skipped or the loop was dropped	Pick up the loop with the hook and place it back on the peg
Fabric is too tight	Wraps are pulled too hard	Wrap loosely and pull the tube down gently now and then
Fabric is too loose	Yarn is too thin for the gauge	Use a thicker yarn or a loom with closer pegs
Loops are hard to lift	Yarn is too thick for the gauge, or wraps are tight	Check the gauge table, and relax your tension
Edges roll up	Stockinette naturally curls	Add garter or ribbed rows at the edges
Stitches look twisted	The wrap went the wrong way around the peg	Take the loop off and reposition it
Panel gets wider	An extra peg was wrapped	Wrap only the number of pegs in the pattern
Cord will not come out of the spool	The tail is stuck or the wraps are tight	Pull the tail gently, and loosen the wraps

PROBLEM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Uneven rows	Tension changes while working	Take breaks, and keep a steady, relaxed hand
Hat top has a hole	Last loops were not gathered tightly	Go through the loops again and pull tight

16. A Four-Week Practice Plan

You will learn faster if you practice in short, regular sessions of 20 to 30 minutes rather than in one long burst. This plan builds each skill on the last.

WEEK	FOCUS	PROJECT
Week 1	Wrapping, the e-wrap cast-on and the knit stitch	Spool cord and the cord bracelet (Project 1)
Week 2	Flat panels, purl and garter, binding off	Coaster set (Project 2) and dishcloth (Project 3)
Week 3	Working in the round, changing yarn	Cowl (Project 6) and ear warmers (Project 10)
Week 4	Decreasing and shaping	Simple hat (Project 5) and fingerless mitts (Project 7)

After week 4, try the headband, the scarf and the baby blanket panels. These are long projects and are a good test of patience and tension.

PRACTICE CHECKLIST

- ☐ I can cast on with an e-wrap
- ☐ I can make a knit stitch with the u-stitch
- ☐ I can make a purl stitch
- ☐ I can work a flat panel and turn at the end of a row
- ☐ I can work in the round and find my first peg
- ☐ I can bind off neatly
- ☐ I can join a new ball of yarn
- ☐ I can pick up a dropped stitch
- ☐ I can decrease for a crown
- ☐ I can gather and close the top of a hat

> **A note about selling**
> If you would like to sell what you make, check the rules of the market or craft fair where you sell.

Next step

Choose one project from this guide and gather the loom and yarn today. If you have never touched a loom, start with the cord bracelet on a small spool, since it takes less than an hour. Keep your notebook beside you,

write down your row counts, and move on to the next project when the last one feels comfortable. Your hands will learn quickly, and each piece you finish will be better than the one before.